

OMAR DERKAOUI

Backend Software Engineer

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PROFILE

Backend-focused software engineer with a track record of shipping production features in fintech and trading platforms. Specialized in NestJS, PostgreSQL/Oracle, and integrating complex legacy banking systems. 1337 Coding School graduate with strong systems fundamentals from C/C++ and a background in mathematics that brings rigor to backend architecture and problem-solving.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Software Engineer

FinaMaze – AI-driven Investment Platform

Feb 2025 – Present Casablanca, Morocco

- Joined as the first backend contributor on a B2B fintech platform serving a major Middle Eastern bank, where AI-driven asset managers build, rebalance, and oversee investment portfolios for the bank's clients.
- Owned end-to-end design and delivery of the onboarding and KYC module, integrating with the bank's legacy SOAP APIs – reverse-engineering undocumented endpoints without a sandbox environment to ship a working flow into UAT.
- Designed Oracle database schemas from scratch for authentication, user onboarding, notifications, and messaging modules; optimized critical queries through targeted indexing strategies.
- Built the notifications and messaging subsystems, including background jobs and queue-based dispatch for asynchronous delivery at scale.
- Implemented JWT/Passport authentication, login and registration flows, and instrumented services with Prometheus for production monitoring.
- Took 6 features through UAT and pre-production while collaborating across a 24-person engineering organization (backend, frontend, DevOps, QA).

Backend Developer

AIKON Mobile App – Connecting Traders

Oct 2024 – Feb 2025 Remote

- Contributed backend features to an iOS social-trading platform that combines messaging and trading workflows in a single mobile experience.
- Designed and built the WhatsApp Business API integration and the surrounding business logic, enabling traders to engage with the platform through a familiar messaging channel.
- Implemented real-time chat assistance using Socket.io, allowing traders to communicate with support agents and other users without leaving the app.
- Modeled the PostgreSQL tables required for the messaging and integration features, and shipped them as part of the production backend.
- Implemented authentication flows with JWT and social login providers; collaborated remotely with a team of 3 backend, 2 frontend, and 1 DevOps engineer.

Full Stack Engineer

Upwork – Freelance

Feb 2024 – Oct 2024 Remote

SKILLS

Backend

- NestJS Node.js Express
- PostgreSQL OracleDB
- TypeORM Redis Socket.io
- JWT / Passport Jest
- Prometheus Firebase Admin
- Nodemailer Puppeteer

Frontend

- Next.js 15 React 19 TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS Zustand
- TanStack Query Radix UI
- Framer Motion React Hook Form
- Zod ECharts Recharts Axios

DevOps

- GitHub Actions Docker

LANGUAGES

- Arabic – Native
- French – Professional
- English – Professional

STRENGTHS

- Full Stack Development
- Backend API Design
- Database Architecture
- Peer Learning & Collaboration
- Entrepreneurial Mindset

HOBBIES

- Competitive Chess (Blitz ELO 2300)
- Geometry & Mathematics Olympiads

- Delivered full-stack web projects end-to-end for international clients — from requirements gathering and architecture through development, deployment, and handover.
- Built backend services with Node.js and Express alongside modern React frontends, handling authentication, data persistence, and third-party integrations.
- First commercial software engineering role; transitioned full-time into tech in February 2024 after 1337 Coding School.

Mathematics Teacher

Ministry of National Education (Morocco)

📅 Sep 2021 – May 2024

📍 Beni Mellal, Morocco

- Taught mathematics to high-school students for three years while transitioning into software engineering through 1337 Coding School — developed strong skills in breaking down complex concepts, which now translate directly into clear technical communication and documentation.
- Designed lesson plans, assessments, and progress tracking, demonstrating autonomy and rigor that carry over to backend system design.

Chess Instructor

Al Akhawayn School

📅 2018 – 2019

📍 Beni Mellal, Morocco

- Coached chess to children aged 6–10 at one of Beni Mellal's largest schools, designing age-appropriate exercises to develop strategic thinking and concentration.
- Competitive player with a peak blitz ELO of 2300.

EDUCATION

Computer Science — Common Core

1337 Coding School

📅 Dec 2018 – Jun 2022

📍 Khouribga, Morocco

- Completed the full common core of an intensive, peer-led, project-based program with no traditional lectures — the Moroccan branch of 42 Network.
- Specialized in low-level systems and computer graphics with C and C++; notable project: a multi-threaded ray tracer rendering complex scenes with realistic lighting.

Bachelor of Science and Technology

FST Beni Mellal

📅 2015 – 2019

📍 Beni Mellal, Morocco

- Electronic Engineering and Telecommunications. Coursework in electronics, signal processing, telecommunications, and industrial computing.